

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Granting Fearlessness to All'

Ārya Sarva Abhaya Pradāna Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 609 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཐམས་ཅད་ལ་མ་འཛགིས་པ་རབ་ཏུ་སྤྱི་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་བྱུངས།

Toh 609 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Sarva Abhaya Pradāna Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Tamché La Mi Jikpa Rabtujinpa Shyejawé Zung, meaning "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Granting Fearlessness to All." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and presents a protective incantation taught by the Buddha during a stay at Indra's Rock cave near the Mango Grove in Magadha. The occasion for the teaching arises when Śakra, lord of the gods, approaches the Buddha to seek relief from the harm and enmity caused by the asuras, suggesting that the dhāraṇī confers protection and freedom from fear upon all who encounter it. As its title indicates, the text's central concern is the bestowal of fearlessness, placing it among the many canonical dhāraṇī texts preserved in the Kangyur that serve both devotional and apotropaic purposes.

In the language of India: Ārya Sarva Abhaya Pradāna Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The noble dhāraṇī called "Granting Fearlessness to All."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, while traveling through the land of Magadha, came to the Mango Grove and took up residence in the cave of Indra's Rock on the hill that rises above the Mango Grove. Then Śakra, lord of the gods — Indra (the king of the divine realm) — went to where the Blessed One was, and arriving there, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat to one side. Seated to one side, Śakra, lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the asuras cause great harm. Blessed One, the asuras have long been my adversarial enemies. Therefore, Blessed One, I pray that you teach me the Dharma."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke to Śakra, lord of the gods, as follows: "Lord of the gods, receive this vidyā mantra that grants fearlessness to all, accomplishes every aim, thoroughly pacifies all fears, thoroughly pacifies all illness, neutralizes all poisons, renders all weapons blunt, renders all footless, two-footed, and four-footed creatures harmless, destroys all enemies, and vanquishes gods, garuḍas, the sons of the giving mother,

flesh-eaters, the cause of forgetfulness, the cause of madness, brahmin spirits, elementals, zombies, bird-demons, the putrid, storm spirits, oppressive demons, oppressors, the demons of forgetfulness, divine demons, nāga demons, yakṣa demons, gandharva demons, kinnara demons, misleading demons, and the demons called māmō. It vanquishes those who steal radiance, those who consume garlands as food, those who consume incense as food, those who consume flowers as food, those who consume burnt offerings as food, those who drink blood as food, those who drink pus as food, those who consume filth as food, and those who drink urine as food. It instills terror in all epidemic diseases, those arising from wind, those arising from bile, those arising from phlegm, those arising from their combination, and beings that walk violent and frightful paths. It thoroughly pacifies all fighting, all quarreling, all discord, and all fault-finding. Receive this. I shall now proclaim the vidyā mantra that grants fearlessness to all."

Thus it goes: ademaḍe pramaḍe, pra vaṃ madiri, gole maboli bose, modde badde, kharadte, karane, graṇa graṇe, gaṇa pragaṇe moṇe, pratimoṇe, kālī prakālī, caṇḍe mahācaṇḍe, praticaṇḍe, vege ativege, sona, gona, mohā, pramohā, mota tramota, nāśāni, pranāśāni, dhavanī, pradhavanī, balaganī, prabalaṇī, nṛtyānī, pranṛtyānī, krodhani, pratikrodhani, hana hana vihana vihana, sarva tuṣṭa praduṣṭa nānāśaya, sarva abhaya prade — protect me together with my retinue from all fears, all demons, and all contagious illnesses. Protect! Protect! May all my aims be accomplished in this very place. And therefore: khidi khidi, cumbhe, sarva sattva hite rate, namaḥ sarva buddhānāṃ svāhā.

Lord of the gods, this vidyā mantra granting fearlessness to all, which has forty-one syllables, should be tied in knots on a cord and bound around one; or a knotted lock of hair may be worn; or it may be recited; or it may be used to consecrate white mustard seed or bezor stone (giwang) by reciting the mantra over them once.

If armor is consecrated with this mantra, it cannot be pierced by weapons, nor harmed by poison, nor by contagious illness, nor by a one-day fever, nor by a two-day fever, nor by a three-day fever, nor by a four-day fever, nor by fire, nor by secret mantras, nor by reanimated corpses, nor by poison, nor by disease; and water will not become the cause of one's death. All vidyā mantras, secret mantras, and ritual workings — any workings that have not yet succeeded will be made to succeed. Those workings that have already succeeded will be rendered invulnerable to interference by others. One will be

freed from bondage imposed by adversaries. The vidyā mantras of others will be cut. One's own vidyā mantras will be increased. All harmful spirits will be destroyed. And if any such spirit refuses to release its hold, its head will split into seven pieces, like the seed-pod of an arjaka plant.

Then Śakra, the lord of the gods (Indra, king of the devas), vanished from that very spot. After the Blessed One had spoken these words, Śakra, the lord of the gods, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

The dhāraṇī called Granting Fearlessness to All Noble Ones is complete.

This was translated, revised, and definitively established in the new orthographic style by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, together with the great editor-translator, the monk Ye shes sde.

Translator's Notes

- The list of spirit-types presents some interpretive challenges. "Srin pa of brahmins" is a compound that likely refers to a class of demonic beings associated with brahmin rites; it has been rendered as "brahmin spirits." The term rendered "sons of the giving mother" translates a literal Tibetan compound whose referent is uncertain in this context. "Māmō" refers to a Tibetan category of wrathful female spirits and is left as a proper name. "Giwang" is a Tibetan term for bezoar stone, a medicinal substance used in ritual applications, rendered plainly in parentheses. The mantra syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering and do not perfectly correspond to reconstructable Sanskrit; they are given as a best-effort phonetic representation without emendation.
- The "arjaka" plant mentioned is likely *Ocimum gratissimum* or a related species known in Sanskrit botanical literature; the image is of a seed-pod splitting into seven fragments, a conventional formula for the destruction of demonic heads in dhāraṇī literature. The passage lists poison twice in the protective enumeration, which reflects the Tibetan source faithfully and may indicate a scribal reduplication in the transmission history, but it is reproduced as given.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly

proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.
May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.